Ulagat Nurtas

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16-year-old founder building AI and hardware products. Founder of Veya (AI eye screening, incubated by StartUp Orda and NIS Incubator). 1st place at Aqmola Power 2026 and Future Minds Hackathon 2026; WRO medalist two years running.

EDUCATION

Nazarbayev Intellectual School, Kokshetau — Expected 2028

STARTUP

Veya, founder (software and AI) — veyaai.vercel.app

AI screening for retinopathy, glaucoma and cataract. An $80 smartphone attachment replaces a $15,000+ fundus camera, so clinics without an ophthalmologist can screen patients.

- Trained an EfficientNet-B0 model on 12,000 labeled fundus images (IDRiD, ODIR-5K); 87% accuracy on a held-out, patient-split test set of 1,800 images
- Designed the v0.4 attachment with co-founder: 11 3D-printed parts, 20D lens, 11 focus positions; risk report and PDF in about 15 seconds
- Interviewed doctors; validated and tested the prototype (Sep 2026)
- Preparing pilots with private clinics in Akmola Region (Q4 2026); first paid contracts planned for Q1 2027
- Incubated by StartUp Orda (Astana Hub) and NIS Incubator

PROJECTS

KozbenSal, eye-tracking glasses — github.com/ulacoder/KozbenSal

Lets people with limited mobility draw, type and control a computer with eye movements and blinks. About $50 to build. 2nd place, WRO 2026 regional.

FMEdu, AI learning platform — github.com/ulacoder/FM-Edu

Personalized learning for grades 7-12. 1st place and 150,000 KZT at Future Minds Hackathon 2026.

Shinobi Motion, gesture-controlled game — shinobi-motion.vercel.app

Browser game played with hand signs in front of a webcam (MediaPipe). Built at Admit Hackathon 2026.

SaqDrone, rescue drone

Autonomous drone that detects a drowning person, flies to them and drops a rescue device.

Mentoria Hub, opportunities platform — mentoria-hub-hazel.vercel.app

Scholarships, olympiads and summer programs in one place, plus online courses and a Telegram bot.

AWARDS

- **Aqmola Power 2026**, 1st place, 250,000 KZT grant
- **Future Minds Hackathon 2026**, 1st place, 150,000 KZT
- **Jas Aqmola** regional akim's youth prize, "Zamannan ozgan" nomination, 500,000 KZT
- **National Founder Cup**, Astana, 4th place
- **WRO**, 2nd place regional (2026), 3rd place (2025)

EXPERIENCE

Freelance web developer — $600 earned

Built and launched websites for restaurants and local businesses, from first call to deployment.

SKILLS

AI / CV: Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenCV, MediaPipe, EfficientNet, Gemini API

Hardware: Arduino, Raspberry Pi, sensors, stepper motors, 3D printing, optics prototyping

Web: TypeScript, Next.js, React, Tailwind, FastAPI, PostgreSQL

Languages: Kazakh, Russian, English | **Interests:** football (playing since age 4), robotics